

भारतीय मानक
Indian Standard

IS 19690 : 2026

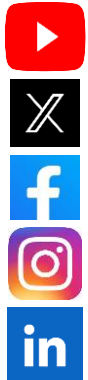
**वीडियो और डिजिटल गेम — आयु-रेटिंग
एवं सामग्री-वर्णन लेबल — विशिष्टि**

**Video and Digital Games —
Age-Rating and Content
Descriptor Labels —
Specification**

ICS 35.240.01

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March 2026

Price Group 7

Media and Entertainment Services Sectional Committee, SSD 13

FOREWORD

This Indian Standard was adopted by the Bureau of Indian Standards, after the draft finalized by the Media and Entertainment Services Sectional Committee had been approved by the Service Sector Division Council.

In the digital age, video games, whether played online or offline, have become a ubiquitous form of digital entertainment for people of all ages. As the nature of these games continues to evolve and diversify, it becomes crucial to provide a clear and consistent framework for age-rating and content description for the benefit of consumers. This enables consumers, particularly parents and guardians, to make informed decisions about the suitability of gaming content for different age groups.

This Indian standard specifies the age-rating labels and content descriptors based on the content of video games and digital games that are published and distributed publicly, including through online mechanisms. By establishing these standards, we aim to promote a safer and more transparent gaming environment, which protects younger audiences from potentially inappropriate content while balancing the creative freedom of game studios.

This standard has been prepared to provide consumers of video games with age-specific content rating information to determine the appropriateness of game content made available within the territory of India. This standard shall be applicable for game publishers and electronic distribution platforms. It provides a clear methodology for categorizing game content and assigning appropriate age ratings, enhancing the overall transparency and accountability within the gaming industry.

The composition of the committee responsible for the formulation of this standard is given in [Annex C](#).

For the purpose of deciding whether a particular requirement of this standard is complied with, the final value, observed or calculated, expressing the result of a test or analysis, shall be rounded off in accordance with IS 2 : 2022 'Rules for rounding off numerical values (*second revision*)'. The number of significant places retained in the rounded off value should be same as that of the specified value in this standard.

Indian Standard

VIDEO AND DIGITAL GAMES — AGE-RATING AND CONTENT DESCRIPTOR LABELS — SPECIFICATION

1 SCOPE

This standard specifies the age-rating labels and content descriptors based on the content of video games and digital games that are published and distributed publicly.

2 REFERENCES

The standards given below contain provisions which, through reference in this text, constitute provision of this standard. At the time of publication, the editions indicated were valid. All standards are subject to revision, and parties to agreements based on this standard are encouraged to investigate the possibility of applying the most recent editions of these standards:

IS No.	Title
IS 19226 : 2025	Media and entertainment — New media services — Vocabulary

3 TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

For the purposes of this standard, the definitions given in IS 19226 and the following shall apply:

3.1 Age-Rating Mark — A classification assigned to video or digital games that indicates the suitability of the content for specific age groups based on the presence of elements such as violence, language, sexual content, or other mature themes.

3.2 Content Descriptor — Terms that accompany and aid an age-rating mark under this standard in providing specific information about the type of content that led to the age-rating classification, which assists consumer in making informed decisions.

3.3 Age-Rating and Content Descriptor Label — Display of age-rating classification and content description categories as specified under this standard for video or digital games.

4 AGE-RATING MARK CATEGORIES

Video or digital games published, or distributed, shall carry the appropriate Age-Rating Mark, in uppercase letters, which may be self-assessed, as provided in [Table 1](#), except in cases of limited display size, as specified under [6.2.5](#) where a modified label may be applicable.

5 CONTENT DESCRIPTORS CATEGORIES

Video or digital games published, or distributed, shall carry the appropriate content descriptors in lowercase letters separated by commas, which may be self-assessed according to content within the game as provided in [Table 2](#), except under the condition of limited display-size, as specified under [6.2.5](#) where a modified label may be applicable.

6 LABELING AND CONSUMER INFORMATION

6.1 Legibility of Label

6.1.1 The age-rating and content descriptor label on video games, or their marketing material, applicable to games made available through physical or digital storefronts, shall be clearly and legibly displayed to ensure easy visibility and understanding.

6.1.2 The age-rating and content descriptor label shall be displayed on the game box art, digital game or app storefronts, television advertisement, digital advertisements, and physical advertisements of the relevant game.

6.1.3 The text, symbols, and background contrast shall be designed to meet the appropriate legibility requirements, enabling clear reading under normal usage conditions.

6.2 Label Size, Proportions and Placement

6.2.1 The age-rating label shall be placed at a prominent location on the primary display panel or the initial viewing screen of the digital storefront for the relevant game.

6.2.2 The outer boundary of the label shall be a square bisected into two equal halves by a single horizontal line. The dimensions of the label shall conform to requirements mentioned in [Fig. 1](#).

6.2.3 The total length of the label shall equal the total width of the label. The length of the upper and lower compartments of the label shall also be equal to each other.

6.2.4 The text constituting the age-rating mark shall be centrally placed in the upper compartment of the label, whereas the text constituting the content descriptor shall be placed within the lower compartment in accordance with the legibility standards.

IS 19690 : 2026

Table 1 Age-Rating Mark Categories

(Clause 4)

SI No.	Age-Rating Mark	Appropriate Use Case Based on In-Game Content
(1)	(2)	(3)
i)	U/A 0+	Applicable to content that is suitable for all ages, and may contain cartoon or fantasy elements. Should not contain any bad language or harmful visuals.
ii)	U/A 3+	Applicable to content that is suitable for ages 3 and up, and may contain cartoon, fantasy, a very mild form of violence or mild language (in a comical context or a childlike setting) is acceptable. No bad language should be heard. The game should not contain any sounds or pictures that are likely to frighten young children.
iii)	U/A 7+	Applicable to content that is suitable for ages 7 and up. May contain unrealistic/mild violence, and/or language to a slightly greater degree than U/A 3+ rated content.
iv)	U/A 13+	Applicable to content that is suitable for ages 13 and up. May contain violence, suggestive themes, crude humour, minimal blood, or infrequent usage of strong abusive language.
v)	U/A 16+	Applicable to content that is suitable for ages 16 and up. May contain intense violence, blood, gore, sexual content, simulated gambling, or very strong and abusive language.
vi)	A	Applicable to content that is suitable for adults only. May contain prolonged scenes of intense violence or graphic sexual content.

Table 2 Content Descriptors Categories

(Clause 5)

SI No.	Content Descriptor	Appropriate Use Case Based on In-Game Content
(1)	(2)	(3)
i)	Violence	Any depiction of brutal physical force intended to harm or kill involving blood, including realistic and fantasy violence.
ii)	Vulgar language	Abusive, vulgar, or derogatory language that may offend and impact the sensibilities of an ordinary viewer.
iii)	Nudity	The depiction of the human body where genitalia, buttocks, or female breasts are exposed, in a sexual or non-sexual context. This descriptor is applicable to either partial or full nudity.
iv)	Sexual content	Content that refers to any depiction or representation of sexual behavior, activities, or themes.
v)	In-game purchases	This descriptor is applicable where the game offers users the option to exchange real-world currency for access to virtual goods, services, or benefits within the game.
vi)	Substance abuse	The portrayal or depiction of the use, consumption, or trafficking of illegal drugs, alcohol, or tobacco, including scenes that glorify or trivialize substance use.
vii)	Gambling	Content that promotes or glorifies betting or gambling activities.
viii)	Socially sensitive themes	Content that significantly relates to social discrimination, race, religious symbols, deities, caste, nationality, gender, physical and mental disability, and which may impact the sentiments of domestic communities.

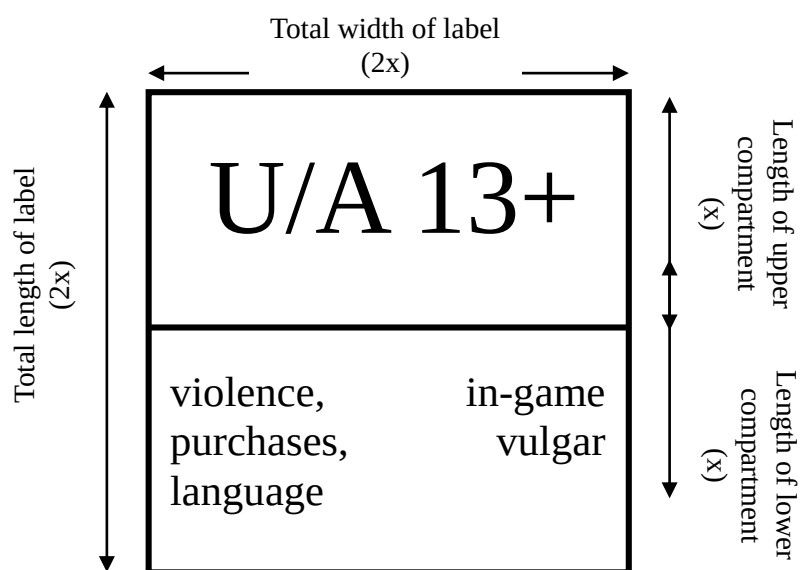


FIG. 1 SAMPLE AGE-RATING AND CONTENT DESCRIPTOR LABEL

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6.2.5 Where user-side display size limitations exist for digital game distribution platforms, digital storefronts and online application marketplaces, modified 34 × 34 pixel or 14 × 14 pixel variants of the age-rating mark may be applied to the game, which shall be integrated with appropriate UI elements, such as information textboxes, to display content descriptors information. All modified variants of the age-rating mark shall conform to the shape, colour, and typographic specifications given in [Annex A](#) — Normative. Illustrative examples of correctly formatted icons are given in [Annex B](#) — Informative.

6.3 Label Colour

All text and shape components constituting the label shall be black in colour, specified using the hexadecimal code #000000. The background and empty space of the label shall be white, specified using the hexadecimal code #FFFFFF. The hexadecimal colour notations specified in this clause

shall conform to the current version of the W3C HTML Living Standard, as maintained by the Web Hypertext Application Technology Working Group (WHATWG).

6.4 Label Typeface

The typeface of all text constituting elements of the label shall be 'Roboto', as maintained and published by Google Fonts at fonts.google.com. The size of text should be adequate to ensure the legibility of all information presented on the label.

6.5 Integrity of Label

Once applied to a game, the age-rating and content descriptor label shall not be edited, obscured, altered, or removed under any circumstances. The label shall remain intact and visible for the duration of the game's availability on any platform to ensure consistent consumer information.

ANNEX A

(Normative)

(Clause [6.2.5](#))

DIGITAL ITEM DIMENSIONS AND DESIGN SPECIFICATIONS

A-1 SHAPE AND DIMENSIONS

A-1.1 The age-rating icon shall be square in shape.

A-1.2 The following two standard sizes are permitted:

- 34 × 34 pixels for app store and high resolution web use (see [Fig. 2A](#)).
- 14 × 14 pixels for small web displays (see [Fig. 2B](#)).

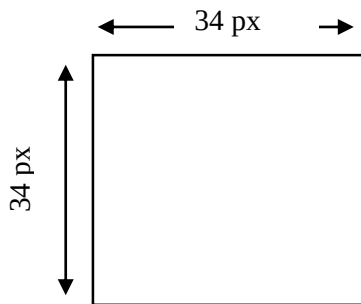


FIG. 2A SHAPE AND DIMENSION OF ICON
FOR APP STORE AND HIGH RESOLUTION
WEB USE

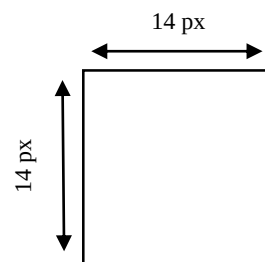


FIG. 2B SHAPE AND DIMENSION
OF ICON FOR SMALL WEB
DISPLAYS

A-2 TYPEFACE

A-2.1 The font for all text shall be 'Roboto', as maintained and published by Google fonts at fonts.google.com.

A-2.2 The text shall be rendered in medium weight for visibility. No additional effects (outline, shadow, gradient) shall be applied.

A-2.3 The illustrative example of the typeface to be used in the icon is given in [Fig. 3](#).

Aa

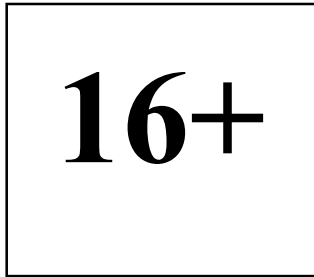
FIG. 3 TYPEFACE

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A-3 COLOUR SPECIFICATION

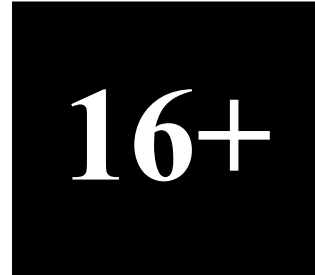
A-3.1 The following two colour schemes are permitted:

- a) Background #FFFFFF and Text #000000 for usage in dark mode (see [Fig. 4A](#)); and
- b) Background #000000 and Text #FFFFFF for usage in light mode (see [Fig. 4B](#)).



FILL COLOUR #FFFFFF
STROKE COLOUR #000000
STROKE WEIGHT 1 UNIT
TEXT COLOUR #000000

FIG. 4A ICON FOR USAGE IN
DARK MODE



FILL COLOUR #000000
STROKE COLOUR #FFFFFF
STROKE WEIGHT 1 UNIT
TEXT COLOUR #FFFFFF

FIG. 4B ICON FOR USAGE IN
LIGHT MODE

A-4 ALIGNMENT AND COMPOSITION

A-4.1 The text shall be centrally aligned both vertically and horizontally.

A-4.2 The icon shall not include any border, stroke, or padding outside the defined pixel area.

A-4.3 The illustrative example for alignment and composition of the icon is given in [Fig. 5](#).

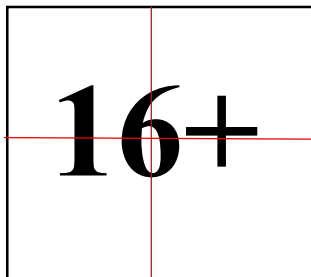


FIG. 5 EXAMPLE FOR ALIGNMENT AND COMPOSITION

A-5 FILE FORMAT AND USAGE

A-5.1 Icons shall be exported as .PNG or .SVG files with transparent background and shall maintain aspect ratio without distortion.

NOTE — Examples of these icons are provided in [Annex B](#).

ANNEX B

(Informative)

(Clause [6.2.5](#))

ILLUSTRATIVE SAMPLES OF AGE-RATING MARKS

B-1 Sample age-rating marks for '0+', '3+', '7+', '13+', '16+' and 'A' categories are given in [Fig. 6](#).

B-2 These graphical samples illustrate the correct typographic proportions and layout of modified variants of age-rating marks for various categories, where display size limitations exist.

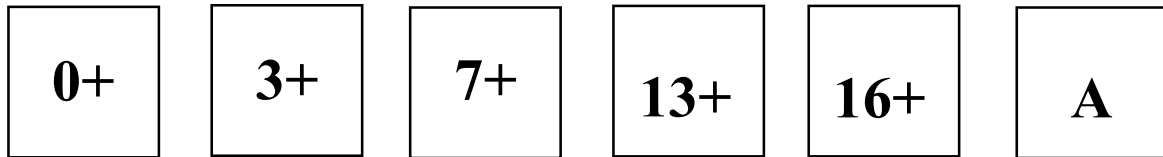


FIG. 6 SAMPLE AGE-RATING MARKS

IS 19690 : 2026

ANNEX C

(Foreword)

COMMITTEE COMPOSITION

Media and Entertainment Services Sectional Committee, SSD 13

<i>Organization</i>	<i>Representative(s)</i>
Asian Academy of Film and Television, Noida	SHRI SANDEEP MARWAH (Chairperson)
All India Gaming Federation, Thane	SHRI DEDIPYAMAN SHUKLA
Central Board of Film Certification, Mumbai	SHRI MAHESH KUMAR
Comscore (Movies) India, Hyderabad	SHRI RAJKUMAR AKELLA
Dolby Technology India Private Limited, Mumbai	SHRI RAJ VARTAK SHRI HAREENDRANATH DWARAK (<i>Alternate</i>)
Event and Entertainment Management Association (EEMA), New Delhi	SHRI VINOD JANARDHAN SHRI ANKUR KALRA (<i>Alternate</i>)
Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry, New Delhi	MS LEENA JAISANI SHRI PANKAJ SINGH (<i>Alternate</i>)
Film and Television Institute of India, Pune	SHRI SUMIT KUMAR SHRI AMLAN CHAKRABORTY (<i>Alternate</i>)
Hotstar (Novi Digital Entertainment), Mumbai	SHRI PARITOSH SAHA SHRI GAJENDRA TIJARE (<i>Alternate</i>)
Indian Broadcasting Foundation, Bangalore	SHRI RADHAKRISHNAN NAIR SHRI GAGAN SAREEN (<i>Alternate I</i>) SHRI GURURAJA RAO (<i>Alternate II</i>) MS SHEENAZ RUSTOM PATEL (<i>Alternate III</i>) MS SIBONEY SAGAR (<i>Alternate IV</i>)
Indian Institute of Technology, New Delhi	MS CHARU MONGA
Indian Music Industry, Mumbai	SHRI BLAISE FERNANDES
Jagran Prakashan Ltd, Kanpur	SHRI BASANT RATHORE SHRI VIPIN KHATWANI (<i>Alternate</i>)
Media and Entertainment Association of India, Bangalore	SHRI ANKUR BHASIN SHRI SUSHIL KUMAR BHASIN (<i>Alternate</i>)
Media and Entertainment Skills Council (MESC), New Delhi	SHRI MOHIT SONI
Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Department of Commerce, New Delhi	SHRI VIPUL BANSAL
Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, New Delhi	SHRI NIRAJ KUMAR
National Law Institute University, Bhopal	SHRI TAPAN R. MOHANTY

<i>Organization</i>	<i>Representative(s)</i>
News Broadcasters & Digital Association (NBDA), Noida	SHRI ANKIT SINGH SHRI RAJ WARIER (<i>Alternate I</i>) SHRI PIYUSH CHAUDHARY (<i>Alternate II</i>)
News Broadcasters Federation, New Delhi	SHRI R. JAI KRISHNA
Newspapers Association of India, Delhi	SHRI VIPIN GAUR SHRI VIKAS KUMAR SHARMA (<i>Alternate I</i>) SHRI B. THOMAS (<i>Alternate II</i>)
PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry, New Delhi	MS SHALINI S SHARMA
Prasar Bharati, New Delhi	SHRI REHAN AHMAD WARSI SHRI RAJEEV KUMAR (<i>Alternate</i>)
PVR Limited, Gurugram	SHRI TARUN KUMAR MAZUMDAR
Services Export Promotion Council, New Delhi	SHRI MOHIT ARORA SHRI PRAVEEN ARORA (<i>Alternate</i>)
Society of Motion Picture and Television Engineers, Mumbai	SHRI UJWAL N. NIRGUDKAR
Telangana VFX Animation and Gaming Association, Hyderabad	SHRI RAJIV CHILAKALAPUDI SHRI ARJUN SARODE (<i>Alternate</i>)
Telecom Regulatory Authority of India, New Delhi	MS SAPNA SHARMA MS SHIVANI SHARMA (<i>Alternate</i>)
Viacom 18 Media Private Limited, Mumbai	SHRI K. ARAVAMUDHAN
Zee Entertainment Enterprises Limited, Mumbai	SHRI AMITABH KUMAR
In Personal Capacity (112 Monisha Tower 4 th Cross Road, Lokhandwala Andheri (W) Mumbai - 400053)	SHRI ATUL CHURAMANI
In Personal Capacity (610, Site-1, Vikaspuri, New Delhi – 110018)	MS SHILPI MEHTA NANDA
In Personal Capacity (1498P, 4th Floor, Saraswati Kunj II, Sector – 52, Wazirabad, Gurugram –122003)	SHRI PRAKASH NARAYANAN
In Personal Capacity (D-2/2701, Cleo County Sector-121, Noida - 201301)	SHRI KUMAR RAAJESH
In Personal Capacity (B7 Delite Apts, 13 th Road, lane opposite KFC Linking Road, next to Excel Entertainment, Khar West Mumbai)	SHRI DHARMESH THAKKAR
BIS Directorate General	SHRI RAJNEESH KHOSLA SCIENTIST 'F'/SENIOR DIRECTOR AND HEAD (SERVICE SECTOR) [REPRESENTING DIRECTOR GENERAL (<i>Ex-officio</i>)]

Member Secretary
SHRI SHIVAM SONI
SCIENTIST 'C'/DEPUTY DIRECTOR
(SERVICE SECTOR), BIS

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Panel for drafting standard on Video and Digital Games – Age - Rating and Content Descriptor Labels –
Specification – SSD 13/P7

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Association of Bangalore Animation Industry (ABAI), Bangalore	SHRI BIREN GHOSE
Confederation of Indian Industry, New Delhi	SHRI GAJENDRA TIJARE SHRI SAMIR KUMAR (<i>Alternate</i>)
Dolby Technology India Pvt Ltd, Mumbai	SHRI RAJESH BHAT
Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce & Industry (FICCI), New Delhi	MS LEENA JAISANI SHRI PANKAJ SINGH (<i>Alternate</i>)
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Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur, Kharagpur	PROF JAYANTA MUKHOPADHYAY
International Chamber of Media & Entertainment Industry (ICMEI), , Noida	SHRI ASHISH GARG
Internet and Mobile Association of India, Mumbai	SHRI JOHN KHIANGTE
Mayhem Studios India Private Limited, Bengaluru	SHRI OJAS VIPAT Ms RITIKA CHATTERJEE (<i>Alternate</i>)
Media and Entertainment Association of India, Bangalore	SHRI ANKUR BHASIN SHRI SUSHIL KUMAR BHASIN (<i>Alternate</i>)
Media & Entertainment Skills Council (MESC), New Delhi	SHRI MOHIT SONI SHRI GAURAV BIRLA (<i>Alternate</i>)
National Institute of Design, Ahmedabad	DR BHAUMIK NAGAR
National Institute of Design, Bhopal	Ms SETU SHARMA
National Institute of Fashion Technology, Delhi	SHRI ANUPAM JAIN
Nazara Technologies Limited, Mumbai	SHRI SUDHIR KAMATH SHRI ANUPRIYA DAS (<i>Alternate</i>)
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Prasar Bharati, New Delhi	SHRI RAJEEV KUMAR SHRI REHAN AHMAD WARSII (<i>Alternate</i>)
Rediff.com Ltd, Mumbai	SHRI AJIT BALAKRISHNAN

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<i>Organization</i>	<i>Representative(s)</i>
Social Media Matters, New Delhi	SHRI AMITABH KUMAR MS PRATISHTHA ARORA (<i>Alternate</i>)
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Viacom 18 Media Private Limited, Mumbai	SHRI K. ARAVAMUDHAN
XSQUADS Tech Private Limited, Surat	SHRI JEMISH LAKHANI SHRI ASHISH DHAMELIYA (<i>Alternate</i>)
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Amendments Issued Since Publication

Amend No.	Date of Issue	Text Affected

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